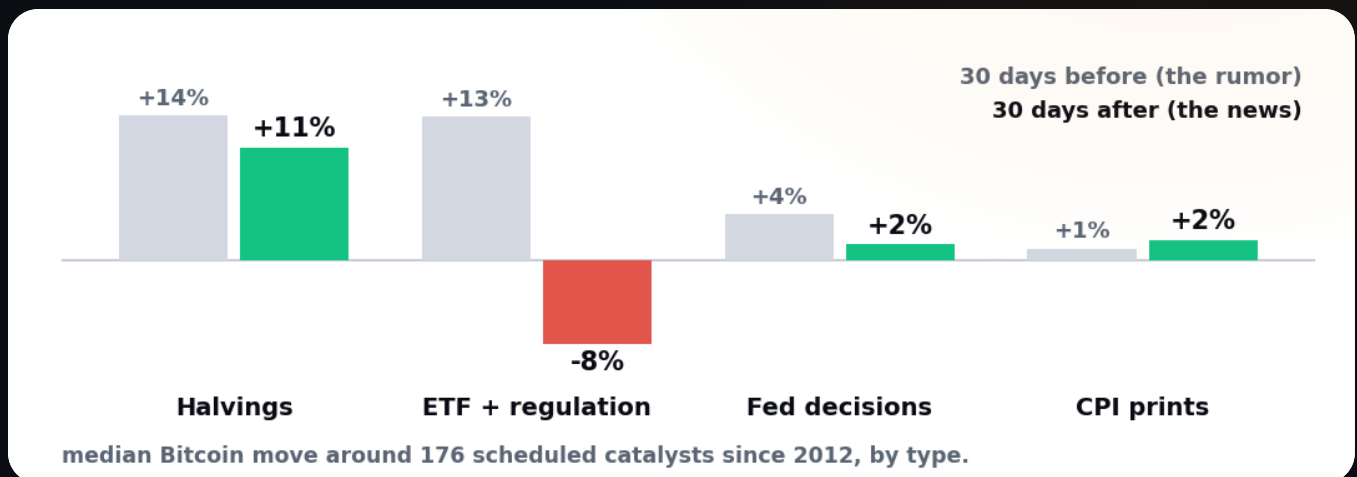


THE RUMOR AND NEWS STUDY

Buy the rumor, sell the news, tested on every big scheduled Bitcoin catalyst since 2012. 176 of them, halvings, spot ETF decisions, big regulatory events, Fed decisions and inflation prints.

What Bitcoin did in the month before each one, the week after and the month after, against any random month.



3 of 4

halvings were higher a month after the event

12 of 15

ETF and regulatory headlines fell the week after

157

Fed decisions and inflation prints that did nothing either way

Educational, not financial advice. The events are scheduled catalysts with a known date, so the run-up is measurable. Surprise news is a different study and is not in here.



Bitcoin Jae
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THE RULE

HOW THE RUMOR AND THE NEWS WERE MEASURED

The rumor. Bitcoin's close 30 days before the event to the close the day before it. If the rule is real, this window is green, because the crowd buys the anticipation. **The news.** The close the day before the event to the close 7, 30 and 90 days after. If the rule is real, this window is red. **The textbook pattern.** A green rumor window followed by a red 30-day news window.

The events. The four halvings. Six spot ETF decisions, including the 2017 and 2018 denials, the 2021 futures ETF green light and the January 2024 approval. Ten scheduled regulatory events, from the December 2017 CME futures launch to Crypto Week in July 2025. Ninety-one Fed decisions and sixty-six US inflation prints. The January 2024 spot ETF approval sits in both the ETF and the regulation lists and is counted once, which leaves 15 ETF and regulatory events.

The baseline. Every 30-day window on Bitcoin since 2012. The median is +3.0%, higher 57% of the time. An event only means something if it moves Bitcoin differently from that. Data is Bitstamp BTC/USD daily closes.

THE SCOREBOARD

IT WORKS ON ONE KIND OF NEWS

EVENT TYPE	N	30D BEFORE / UP	7D AFTER	30D AFTER / DOWN	90D AFTER	TEXTBOOK
Halvings	4	+13.5% / 3 of 4	+4.6%	+10.5% / 1 of 4	+19.2%	1 of 4
Spot ETF decisions and big regulation	15	+13.4% / 12 of 15	-7.8%	-7.8% / 10 of 15	-9.6%	8 of 15
Fed decisions	91	+4.3% / 56 of 91	+0.4%	+1.5% / 44 of 91	+9.1%	26 of 91
CPI prints	66	+1.1% / 34 of 66	+1.0%	+1.9% / 30 of 66	-1.4%	16 of 66
Any 30 days since 2012	5,349	+3.0%		+3.0%		

Medians. 'up' = count with a higher close before the event, 'down' = count with a lower close 30 days after.

The halving, the event most often sold as 'sell the news', was the one where it failed. Bitcoin ran up into three of the four, and was higher 30 days after three of the four, a median +11%. The Fed and inflation prints did almost nothing in either window, within a point or two of any random month.

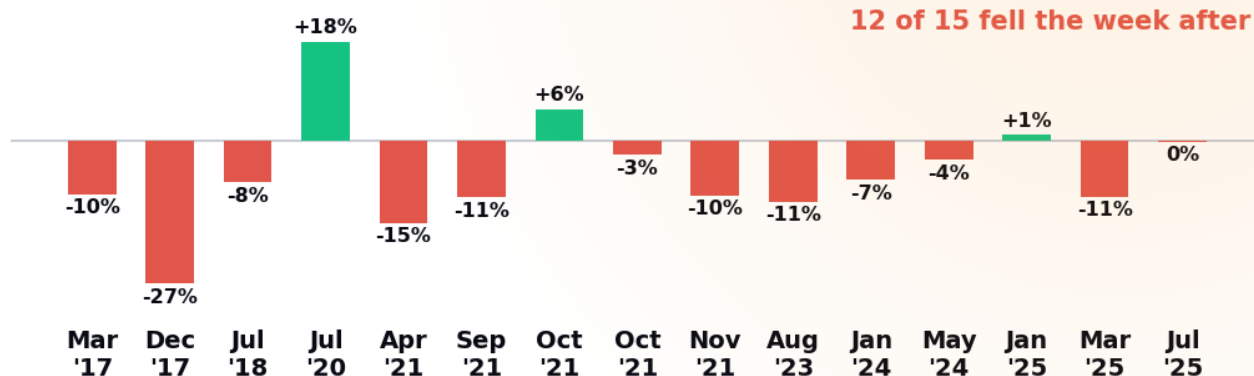
The pattern is real for one group, spot ETF decisions and big regulatory events. Bitcoin ran up into 12 of 15, fell in the week after 12 of 15, and was a median -8% a month later. The sell mostly happened fast, in the first week.

ALL 15 HEADLINES

DATE	EVENT	30D BEFORE	7D AFTER	30D AFTER	90D AFTER	TEXTBOOK
10 Mar 2017	Winklevoss spot ETF decision (deny)	+13%	-10%	+1%	+136%	
18 Dec 2017	CME BTC futures launch	+144%	-27%	-41%	-57%	yes
26 Jul 2018	Winklevoss II spot ETF decision (deny)	+35%	-8%	-18%	-22%	yes
22 Jul 2020	OCC bank custody letter	-3%	+18%	+23%	+27%	
14 Apr 2021	Coinbase IPO	+14%	-15%	-22%	-49%	yes
07 Sep 2021	El Salvador legal tender	+20%	-11%	+2%	-4%	
15 Oct 2021	Futures ETF green light (approve)	+19%	+6%	+14%	-26%	
19 Oct 2021	BITO futures ETF launch	+31%	-3%	-8%	-32%	yes
12 Nov 2021	VanEck spot ETF deadline (deny)	+13%	-10%	-23%	-33%	yes
11 Aug 2023	ARK 21Shares first deadline (delay)	-3%	-11%	-12%	+25%	
10 Jan 2024	Spot ETF final decision (approve)	+12%	-7%	+2%	+50%	
22 May 2024	FIT21 passes House	+5%	-4%	-9%	-16%	yes
23 Jan 2025	Trump digital-asset EO	+5%	+1%	-7%	-10%	yes
06 Mar 2025	Strategic BTC Reserve EO	-7%	-11%	-8%	+16%	
17 Jul 2025	Crypto Week GENIUS+CLARITY	+14%	-0%	-1%	-7%	yes

Textbook = green 30 days before and red 30 days after.

THE BIGGEST ONES, AND THE HYPE TEST



Bitcoin 7 days after every spot ETF decision and big regulatory event since 2017.

December 2017, the CME futures launch. Bitcoin rose 144% in the month before, the biggest run-up of any event in the study, and fell 41% in the month after. It was the top of that cycle.

April 2021, the Coinbase IPO. A 14% run-up, then down 15% in a week and 22% in a month.

October 2021, the BITO futures ETF launch. A 31% run-up, then down 8% in a month and 32% three months later.

January 2024, the spot ETF approval. A 12% run-up, down 7% in the week after, then up 50% three months later. The sell was real and it lasted a week. That is the most common shape in this group. The headline gets sold, and what happens after the first week depends on the market around it.

RUN-UP INTO THE EVENT	N	WEEK AFTER RED	30D AFTER MEDIAN	30D AFTER LOWER
10% or more	10	9 of 10	-4.7%	6 of 10
under 10%	5	3 of 5	-7.8%	4 of 5

ETF and regulatory events only.

The size of the run-up did not change much. Big run-up or small, the headline mostly got sold.

THE MYTHS HALVINGS, THE FED AND INFLATION

DATE	EVENT	30D BEFORE	7D AFTER	30D AFTER	90D AFTER	TEXTBOOK
28 Nov 2012	Halving 1 (block 210k)	+12%	+9%	+9%	+158%	
09 Jul 2016	Halving 2 (block 420k)	+15%	-0%	-11%	-7%	yes
11 May 2020	Halving 3 (block 630k)	+27%	+11%	+13%	+34%	
20 Apr 2024	Halving 4 (block 840k UTC)	-3%	-1%	+12%	+5%	

All four halvings. Only 2016 fit the textbook.

YEAR	FED DECISIONS	30D BEFORE	30D AFTER	CPI PRINTS	30D BEFORE	30D AFTER
2015	8	+11%	+0%	0		
2016	8	+7%	+4%	0		
2017	8	+25%	+44%	0		
2018	8	-14%	-3%	0		
2019	8	-2%	+13%	0		
2020	7	+19%	+5%	0		
2021	8	+5%	-1%	12	+9%	+2%
2022	8	-10%	-2%	12	-5%	-7%
2023	8	+9%	-0%	12	+4%	+14%
2024	8	+6%	+7%	12	+6%	+4%
2025	8	-0%	-5%	11	-0%	+1%
2026	4	+5%	-3%	7	-0%	+4%

Medians by year. The CPI list starts in 2021.

Year by year, the Fed and inflation windows track whatever the market was already doing that year. There is no consistent run-up into a decision and no consistent sell after it.

THE LIVE CASE

SEPTEMBER 2026, SO FAR THE OPPOSITE

On 15 September 2026 the Senate failed to advance the CLARITY Act, 49 to 50. Two days later, on 17 September, the SEC issued two five-year exemptions that let tokenized US stocks trade on blockchain venues. Bitcoin had risen about 18% in the month before the SEC news.

By this study that is the setup for a sell in the week after. Instead Bitcoin rallied, broke \$82,833 on 21 September, and was about 11% above its 16 September close six days later. So far the market bought this headline rather than selling it. One exception does not overturn fifteen events, and the 30-day window does not close until 17 October.

THE READ

Buy the rumor, sell the news is a myth for halvings and macro, and mostly true for ETF and regulatory headlines in the first week. Trade the type of headline, not the slogan. This is a study, not a call.

THE HONEST LIMITS

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

Fifteen ETF and regulatory events. The group where the rule works is the smallest in the study. It is a lean, not a law.

Four halvings. Nobody should build a view on four data points, which is also the best argument against the confident halving narratives in both directions.

The event list is a choice. These are the big scheduled catalysts with a known date. A different list, or surprise news, could give a different answer.

The windows overlap the market. Thirty days before and after an event is also thirty days of everything else. The baseline is there to separate the event from an ordinary month, and it only partly does.

Data pinned 23 September 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily closes. Event lists from the Bitcoin Daily event-study harness. Scripts: RumorNews/rn_study.py, rn_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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